

Emma Nelson

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Education

PhD, Sociology (in progress)

Dalhousie University
2025 – present

Master, Environmental Studies

Diploma, Community Planning
Diploma, Environmental Education
York University
2018 – 2020

Master, English

York University
2017 – 2018

Bachelor, English Literature

Minor, Gender Studies
Montana State University
2013 – 2017

Awards

SSHRC CGS Doctoral

2025 – 2028

Dalhousie President's Award

2025 – 2027

MES thesis nominated for Outstanding Paper Series

Feb 2020

SSHRC Partnership Engage

Feb 2020

SSHRC CGS Master's

2019 – 2020

York Graduate Fellowship

2017 – 2019

York Graduate Scholarship

2017 – 2019

Inkling Award

May 2016

Montana State University

President's Scholarship

Sept 2013

Experience

Research assistant — Dalhousie University and InclusionNS

July 2026 – ongoing

- Supported by MITACS Accelerate
- Scoping review of deinstitutionalization of community living facilities for people with mental disabilities across Canada
- Second phase planned for 2027: interviewing community members and providers, data analysis, presentation and publication of results

Teaching assistant — Dalhousie University

September 2025 – ongoing

- Grading and advising for 2000 and 3000-level courses

Writing tutor — Dalhousie University Writing Centre

September 2025 – ongoing

- Drafting, grammar, clarity, and copyediting assistance

Owner-operator — Cardamom Pod Cafe

January 2023 – August 2025

- Small cafe located in Pugwash, NS
- Baker, barista, and social media manager

Research assistant — York University

July – Dec 2020

- Created database of land transfers between Indigenous nations and the Crown between 1790–mid 1900s
- Mapped findings using GIS to show the development of Canada as dependent on the degradation of Indigenous land holdings

Research assistant — York University

Feb – Oct 2020

- Supported by SSHRC Partnership Engage
- Joint project with City of Toronto's Shelter, Support, and Housing Administration
- Interviewed international experts and service providers on difficulties with public engagement when introducing new shelters

Presentations & publications

Presenter CSA, "'Return of the 'Radical': How the history of Nova Scotian midwifery can inform feminist organizing"

June 2026

Presenter CSA, "Mapping Memories: An interactive method to recover, visualize, and celebrate midwifery's history in Nova Scotia"

June 2026

Presenter CASCA, "Is there a place for contemplative practice in anthropology? On silence, listening, and hearing in the field"

June 2026

Skills

- Qualitative methods
- Multiple regression analysis
- Designing visuals (interactive, graphic design, textile art)
- Digital mapping
- Grant writing

Software familiarity

- Linux
- QGIS
- Stata 18
- NVivo / hand coding
- Excel (intermediate)
- InDesign
- LaTeX, VS Code
- Microsoft & Google suites
- Canva
- Social media management (major platforms)

Interests

- Midwifery / birth care
- Death care / death cultures
- Rites of passage
- Ritual
- Professionalization
- Medicalization
- Nursing history
- Policy development
- Material cultures
- Participant-driven research
- Alternative / visual methods

Co-author "Reconciling Relationships with the Land Through Land Acknowledgments" with Dr. Deborah McGregor in *Sacred Civics*
May 2022

Author [Container gardening: A how-to](#) (self-published)
Jul 2021

Producer [Planning through land acknowledgments](#) (podcast)
Aug 2020

Guest lecturer Several conferences and university courses, "Understanding land acknowledgments"
Aug 2020-May 2024

Co-author York University, "Understanding Cummer Lodge as a place of employment"
Apr 2020

Co-author York University, "NYC and Toronto: From mega-projects to activism and resistance"
Oct 2019

Presenter Law Union of Ontario Conference, "Legal observing and activism"
Oct 2019

Extracurricular

OpenThinker — [OpenThink 2026 cohort](#), Dalhousie University
2026 – 2027

- Competitively selected, stipended programme designed to help early-career scholars develop a public following for their research
- Received media training

Student Concerns Subcommittee, Eastern Rep — Canadian Sociological Association
2026 – 2029

- Elected for 3-year term

Trained birth doula — Sista Midwife Productions
2020 – current